So the question is why students drop off after the free trial on an edtech platform. Before jumping to answers, I want to break this down into where they drop off, then why.

First, I'd map the trial as a funnel instead of treating it as one big period. Something like signup, first lesson completed, mid-trial engagement, day before trial expiry, and conversion. I'd pull the drop-off rate at each of these stages from whatever product analytics tool they use, Mixpanel, Amplitude, or GA. That tells me where the biggest cliff is, instead of guessing which part of the experience is broken.

Once I know where the drop happens, I'd segment that specific stage by device, acquisition channel, signup cohort, and content type. So if the drop is after lesson one, is it worse on mobile? Worse for users who came from paid ads versus organic? That tells me if this is a universal problem or specific to one group, which changes the fix.

Numbers tell me where, not why. So next I'd look at session recordings or heatmaps for a sample of users who dropped at that stage. I'd also check support tickets or NPS feedback from churned users, and if I can, send a short exit survey or do a few quick interviews with people who left.

Say the data shows drop-off spikes right after lesson one. My hypothesis might be that onboarding doesn't show value fast enough. I wouldn't just ship a fix, I'd A/B test it, for example a shorter first lesson, and measure if it moves the day-two retention number before rolling it out fully.

I'd prioritize whichever drop-off point is biggest and cheapest to fix first, then iterate from there.